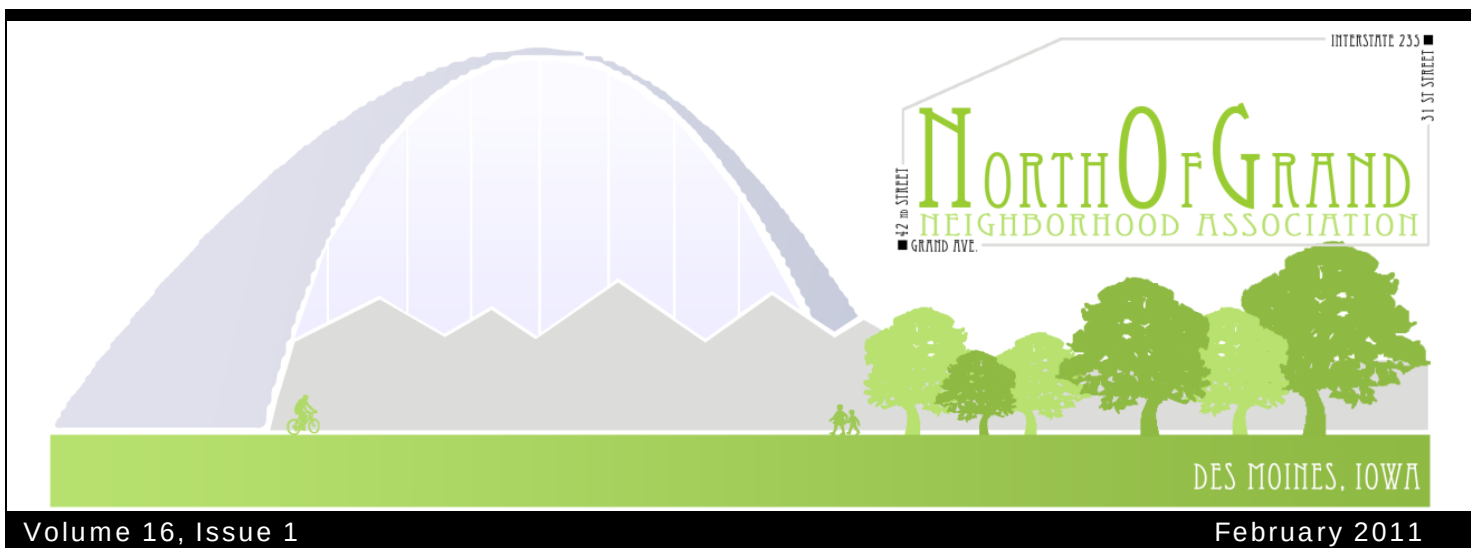




NOG Quarterly Meeting

Tuesday, February 15th at 7 pm
Grand Suites
3801 Grand Avenue

Guest Speakers:

Soozie McBroom

Restoration Ingersoll

Will give a general update on the next steps, possible timeline, and describe opportunities for involvement.

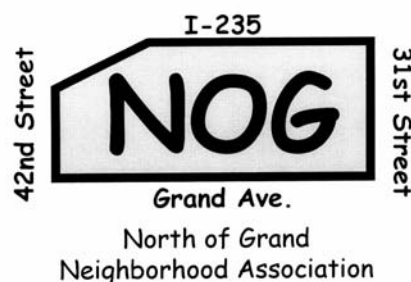
TREES AVAILABLE

"Want a tree? Request a tree be planted in front of your home. Requests must be received by City Forestry no later than March 15, 2011. Send requests for street trees to the Forestry Office via email to Andy Foster at wafoster@dmgov.org or call in your requests at 515-283-4950. If approved for a tree, forestry staff will schedule a tree planting for spring or fall."

In addition, NOG has 8 cherry trees for sale for \$35 each. Please contact Ben Molloy for additional information 277-4387 or yurikakanai-molloy@mchsi.com

In This Issue:

- Quarterly Meeting
- 2011 Membership Drive
- Center-Soll then, NOG now
- Featured Neighbors: Justin and Emily Gross
- Did You Know?
- May Meeting
- Renovation Boot Camp



2011 MEMBERSHIP DUES

**NOG Members –
We value your support in 2011**

In efforts to streamline the process of how North of Grand memberships are renewed - We are switching to sending out a paper invoice in February to everyone. The amount due will be your dues for the calendar year of 2011.

By joining or renewing your NOG membership, you provide crucial support for annual events such as the neighborhood wide Garage Sale, Picnic, National Night Out, and Centennial Celebrations. In addition, valuable service projects are made possible including Scrub Day, Fall and Spring I-235 Clean-up, and the corner plantings.

If you have any questions - please contact Kimberly Hansen at 279-2684.

OUR MISSION

The neighborhood association's mission is to ensure that existing and projected infrastructure systems are managed or developed so they enhance the physical, visual and spatial qualities of the neighborhood — promoting a healthy climate for area businesses, and public and private properties.



“CENTER-SOLL CLUB”

By Colleen Kinney

In November 1924, Better Homes and Gardens published an article entitled, “Getting Neighborliness In Your Neighborhood,” which described how a few individuals created the “Center-Soll Club” in Des Moines, Iowa. By planning a few events each year, they bonded to eliminate eyesores and crime.

Today, Center-Soll has expanded by a few blocks, and is now known as “North of Grand.” Our group continues to organize neighborhood events, like our family-friendly annual picnic, Scrub Day and National Night Out activities, to strengthen connections, reduce blight and curb crime, while having a fun time. These events are also an opportunity for neighbors to get to know their neighbors, which is useful in building crime-free, vibrant communities where residents develop a sense of pride and invest in their “village.” This echoes the Better Homes and Gardens editorial comments from 1924: “Des Moines, Iowa, has pointed out in a movement ... that the way to have a good neighbor is to be one; that good neighborhoods do not ‘just grow,’ but that they come as the result of intelligent cooperative effort on the part of the families making up the neighborhood... (p. 8)”

We welcome you to participate in North of Grand activities and see how neighborliness is still strong, even after many decades. As advocated in the 1924 Better Homes and Gardens editorial comments: “The need exists practically everywhere for a more ‘human unit’ than the units into which we are drawn by the economic forces which have become to largely govern even our social relationship with each other.” As neighbors we look out for one another, and our lives are more fulfilling because of these connections. Sure problems still exist, but by tackling them at the neighborhood block level, resolving conflicts can become manageable.



MEET THE NEIGHBORS: JUSTIN AND EMILY GROSS

Emily and I have lived in the neighborhood for close to three years. We really wanted to live in this neighborhood because of the closeness to downtown and the urban setting. Another nice feature about living in NOG is the fact that Emily’s business, Taste to Go and Catering is about a mile and half away on the corner of University and Polk Boulevard. Emily has owned taste to go for six years. I work close to downtown in the United Way Building so travel to and from work for me is also very easy. I work for Iowa Legal Aid as an attorney. Iowa Legal Aid is an organization that assists low to moderate income individuals and families with civil law issues.

In May of 2009 Emily and I had our first child, Jude. He is now eighteen months old and is walking, talking, and full of energy and curiosity. We love the fact that there are schools in the neighborhood that are excellent in academics with teachers that are passionate about teaching. We plan to live in NOG for a very long time and hope in the near future to get more involved in our community and get to know our neighbors. Thanks for taking the time to get to know us through this article.



DID YOU KNOW?? WHAT CAN I PUT ON THE CURB?

Des Moines City ordinance prohibits the placement of junk, debris, branches, limbs abandoned furnishings, or other property on any City right-of-way. This includes the curb in front of your property **and the alley behind**. The exception is regular weekly refuse pick up with your city supplied containers. These may be placed on the right-of-way for regular pick-up 12 hours before collection and remain on the right-of-way for no more than 12 hours after collection.

SEC. 98-54.3 (d). *No person shall deposit solid waste or solid waste containers upon the parking or terrace of the street in front of premises more than 12 hours before the date designated for solid waste collection. No person shall allow solid waste containers to remain on the parking or terrace of the street in front of that person's premises for more than 12 hours after the date designated for solid waste collections.*

You must use city supplied containers only. Materials that do not fit in containers: furniture and big items bundled wood etc must have purchased stickers on them before they will be picked up. "Large Item" stickers are \$5.00 ea. You would need one per each large item and you can only have up to 5 large items per week. For yard debris you must use marked "metro waste authority" bags or put a "yard debris sticker", \$1.00 per sticker, on any other bag. You must also put a yard debris sticker on bundles of limbs or branches to be picked up. These stickers can be purchased at Dahls, Hy Vee, City Hall, and some hardware stores. Be sure to designate large item sticker or yard waste sticker.

Anything on the curb/alley "public right of way" other than the designated hours of pick-up will be considered "abandoned property" and in violation of city ordinance.

Once the city becomes aware of a violation it will be tagged with an orange sticker and, if not removed by the owner in 4 days the city will remove and dispose of the material at the expense of the abutting property owner.

Sec. 42-361. *Abandoned property in the right-of-way.*

(a) Property left in the public right-of-way of any road or alley, including but not limited to any personal and household items, furniture, appliances, machinery, equipment, building materials or other items shall be deemed abandoned and shall constitute a violation of this article and are hereby declared a public nuisance. Property left on the public right-of-way as a result of an eviction or a forcible entry and detainer action shall be deemed abandoned and are hereby declared a public nuisance.

(b) The abutting property owner is required to maintain all property outside the lot lines and property lines and inside the curb lines or the travelled portion of the public streets or alleys. Any items which remain on the public right-of-way or any road or alley for a period of 48 hours shall be deemed abandoned and to constitute a public nuisance subject to removal from the real estate by the city with or without notice.

(c) It shall not be a defense to this article that the public works department of the city has been contacted for a bulk waste pick up, if the items were placed on the curb or right-of-way prior to the pick up date assigned by the public works department.

(d) The costs of the abatement will be assessed against the abutting real estate from which the nuisance was abated for collection in the same manner as a property tax if notice has been served.

(e) Service to the notice shall be by regular mail, addressed to the owner of the real estate abutting the property and/or the person deemed responsible for the real estate abutting the public right-of-way four days in advance of the abatement. The notice shall contain information, which reasonably appraises the party notified of the nature of the nuisance.

If you have any questions on the above ordinances please call me.

Ed Leedom
515-283-4183-off.
515-208-0299-cell
elleedom@dmgov.org



CHANGE OF VENUE FOR MAY QUARTERLY MEETING

The North of Grand quarterly meeting in May will be held at a special location. Please join us at 7 p.m. May 9th at St. Augustin Catholic Church, 545 42nd Street (at Grand Avenue). Longtime NOG resident, architect and church member Dane Shelton will speak about the church's fascinating architecture, and specifically show visitors the church's historic stained glass windows. The presentation is free and open to the public. Please use the east entrance (by the parking lot).

RENOVATION BOOT CAMP

Renovation Boot Camp is a classroom seminar series designed to give participants a basic understanding of the renovation process from purchase to project completion. The classes will help demystify the process by providing practical advice, support and encouragement, and resources for a successful renovation project.

Topics covered in this session include:

- * Why renovate in a build-it-new world
- * Renovation Timeline: What to expect and plan for in the process

Classes will take place Mondays from 6 p.m. to 8 p.m. at Smokey Row, 1910 Cottage Grove, Des Moines (in the Sherman Hill neighborhood). Attend one class or the whole series: pre-register and pay for classes online for a discount! Fees help offset the cost of event space, advertising, refreshments, and printing.

- * First Class: March 21st, 2011
 - * Individual class (on-site registration): \$8
 - * 8 Class Series (register online or at the first class): \$45
- For more info, see <http://classes.renovatedsm.com> or call 515-710-3484.

The series is underwritten by Castle and Cooke Mortgage and presented in conjunction with Urban Ambassadors.



Open House 1-4 p.m., Feb. 13th
632 40th Street, Des Moines, IA
Ralph Stonehocker
Phone: 515-271-7739

Century-old American Foursquare within walking distance to Ingersoll shops, Plymouth Church, and Greenwood Elementary. Convenient commute to downtown. Classic front porch overlooks large front yard with mature oak trees. Charming interior with traditional woodwork, crown molding, and large, bayed windows. Refinished hardwood floors. New kitchen and master bath features designer cabinetry & granite countertops. Stainless appliances. Energy-efficient improvements, such as zoned A/C.



North of Grand
Neighborhood Association

NOG Members

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2011 Dues:

General Membership is open to everyone.

Voting members must live, work, rent, or own property within the
NOG boundaries

Individual:	\$12 per year
Household:	\$22 per year
Business:	\$30 per year
Patron:	\$50 per year

North of Grand Neighborhood Association
P.O. Box 12027
Des Moines, IA 50312

2011 Membership Invoices

To be mailed week of Feb. 14th

We value your support in 2011!

North of Grand Neighborhood Association Board of Directors

- **President:** Kimberly Hansen 279-2684
kimberlymhansen@aol.com
- **Vice President:** Mark Siegfried 255-7667
Marksally2@mchsi.com
- **Treasurer:** Matt Braafhart 279-6945
matt@braafhart.com
- **Co-Secretary:** Mathew Coen 274-9513
mcoen@StudioCOENarch.com
- **Co-Secretary:** Sarah Oltrogge
sarah.oltrogge@earthlink.net
- **At Large:** Ben Molloy 277-4387
yurikakanai-molloy@mchsi.com
- **At Large:** Shawn Miller 221-2989
miller.shawn@principal.com
- **At Large:** Colleen Kinney 664-9183
mcfet6@mchsi.com
- **At Large:** Nathan DeCock 943-6008
nfdecock@gmail.com
- **At Large:** Jon Soliday 238-6079
jons@2rm.com

www.northofgrandneighborhood.org

Find us on FACEBOOK: North of Grand DSM

Hope to see you at our meeting on February 15th
